

CHINONSO KALU

SOFTWARE ENGINEER | BACKEND & AUTOMATION

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 5+ years of professional experience building, integrating, deploying, and supporting web applications and backend systems with PHP and Laravel. Strong in clean architecture, REST APIs, relational databases, third-party integrations, asynchronous processing, cloud deployment, and CI/CD. Experienced with financial transaction systems, high-volume workflows, system reliability, and cross-functional delivery. Interested in automation, information systems, and building reliable software that reduces manual operational work.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: PHP, JavaScript, Python (intermediate)

Frameworks: Laravel, Symfony, React.js, Smarty

Backend: REST APIs, Event-driven services, Queues, DTOs, Clean Architecture, Third-party integrations

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL

Cloud & DevOps: Docker, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, AWS (Fargate, S3, Lambda), DigitalOcean, Linux

Testing: PHPUnit, Unit Testing, Feature Testing

Other: Payment integrations, Core Banking integrations, Security practices, Technical documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Application Support Analyst — MTN Nigeria | Lagos, Nigeria | Sep 2022 – Aug 2026

- Developed and maintained internal web applications using PHP and WordPress while supporting business-critical digital platforms.
- Collaborated with UNIX, Networking, Database, Security, and Marketing teams to troubleshoot issues and deliver high-impact technical changes.
- Optimized database queries and application components to improve system performance and reduce unnecessary load.
- Supported security, server, and content-compliance requirements, including ARCON-related controls and vulnerability remediation activities.
- Produced technical documentation and user guides and mentored engineering interns on development and support practices.

Full-Stack Developer — Ritemate Technologies | Lagos, Nigeria | 2026

- Delivered software development and application-support work within a client-facing technology environment.
- Worked across backend, frontend, deployment, troubleshooting, and stakeholder-facing activities to support reliable application delivery.
- Collaborated with client-side technical teams to investigate issues, implement fixes, and maintain production-facing systems.

Lead Backend Engineer — Retruest Microfinance Application | Remote | Apr 2025 – Apr 2026

- Architected and built the backend for a microfinance banking system covering loans, savings, inter-bank transfers, and digital wallets.
- Applied Action-Service-Repository architecture and DTOs to produce maintainable, testable, and well-structured application code.
- Integrated Qore/BankOne core banking services and Monnify/Sudo payment services for account creation, automated debits, and single/batch disbursements.
- Designed fault-tolerant transaction flows using double-entry ledgers, webhook processing, ACID database transactions, and rollback handling.
- Used Laravel Jobs and Redis queues to process high-volume synchronization, notifications, and other asynchronous workloads.

Backend Engineer — Atlas Trailer, Canada | Remote | Dec 2021 – Feb 2023

- Built and maintained Laravel backend services for high-volume booking and wholesale order workflows.
- Developed resilient REST APIs and integrated payment and logistics providers.
- Configured CI/CD pipelines and managed DigitalOcean infrastructure, including automated database backups and SSL provisioning.
- Performed code reviews, application performance optimization, and Agile delivery support while mentoring junior developers.

Backend Engineer — Aladdin Digital | Remote | Apr 2021 – Mar 2022

- Designed and developed custom Laravel applications with responsive user interfaces.
- Integrated third-party APIs and payment gateways to support evolving business requirements.
- Deployed applications to cloud environments with attention to availability, scalability, and SSL compliance.
- Worked directly with clients and stakeholders to translate requirements into practical technical solutions.

SELECTED PROJECTS

COC Unite Application | Laravel, React.js

Built a church community platform for groups, events, and attendance with real-time notifications, access control, and modular backend design.

Blacklist Limited – Credit Management System | PHP/Laravel, Database

Developed and maintained backend functionality for tracking, managing, and restricting accounts with outstanding obligations, with emphasis on data accuracy and reliability.

CSMT Schools Admission System | WordPress, PHP, DigitalOcean

Implemented an online admission workflow with application processing, payments, scheduled exam credential generation, and automated parent email delivery.

Osamede.net | WordPress, PHP, Server Infrastructure

Developed and maintained a corporate website, including plugin optimization and server infrastructure support.

Freelance WordPress Engineering | WordPress, Elementor, Custom PHP

Delivered platforms for education, hospitality, and B2B IT consulting clients, including custom themes, admissions integrations, booking lead generation, deployment, SSL, and security setup.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science — Nnamdi Azikiwe University | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- ALX x Udacity Full Stack Program — Python, Flask, SQLAlchemy, PostgreSQL (2022)
- TripleByte Engineering Certificate (2022)
- SlateCube Full Stack Web Development — HTML, CSS, JavaScript (2020)

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

- Sponsored, organized, and facilitated an 8-day free digital literacy technical training bootcamp for 600+ youths in Lagos.
- Provided pro-bono DevOps and development support to Chess in Slums Africa, including AWS website hosting and an internal admin dashboard.